# Disjoint Set Union (DSU)

Helps to perform grouping operations




- union -> augmentation using which we can group elements together
- find -> augmentation using which we can find which group an element belongs to

union(1,2) -> we want to group 1 and 2 together

union(3,4) union(2,3) find(4) -> 1 find(2) -> 2 find(1) -> 1 find(3) -> 1




How to build DSU

We need two main functions to build DSU:
- union
- find




index -> element
arr[index] -> parent of the group where the element belongs

find(2) -> 2 union(1,2) union(3,4) union(2,4)

Function find(x) {
return arr[x] // O(1)
}

new parent here will be either the parent of 2 or parent of 4 -> randomly I picked 3 to be the parent

function union(x, y) { // O(n)
px = find(x)
py = find(y)

// final parent is px

for(i = 0; i < n; i++) {
if (arr[i] == py) arr[i] = px;
}

all the elements of py now will be part of px, so wherever in the dsu array u find parent to be py update all of those parents to px

}




function union(x, y) { //O(n)

px = find(x)
py = find(y)

arr[px] = py; // make the parent of px as py

}

function find(x) { // O(1)

Object[x] == x) return x;
return find(arr[x]);

}

find(2) -> find(3)-> find(3)

Union By Size

Don't randomly assign the parent, always keep the parent of the group which is bigger in size




union(1, 2)

union(3, 4)

union(3, 5)

union(1, 5)




Attaching the smaller in bigger group

function union(x, y) { // O(log n)

px = find(x)
py = find(y)

sx = size[px]
sy = size[py]

if(sx > sy) {
arr[py] = px; // make py the leader
size[px] += size[py]
} else {
arr[px] = py;
size[py] += size[px]
}

}

function find(x) { // O(log n)
if(arr[x] == x) return x;
return find(arr[x]);
}




union(3, 8)



max operations to find parent of any element is just 3



max operation needed to find parent of any element is 4




Approx how much the max ops look like ?

approx log(size) + 1

The maximum number of operations with this approach to find parent of any element is

log(size) + 1

Worst case: O(log(n))

Union by rank

function union(x, y) { // O(log n)

px = find(x)
py = find(y)

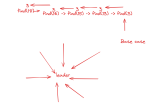
sx = rank[px]
sy = rank[py]

if(sx > sy) {
arr[py] = px; // make px the leader
rank[px] += 1
} else {
arr[px] = py;
rank[py] += 1
}

}

Path compression




function find(x) {
if(arr[x] == x) return x;
arr[x] = find(arr[x]);
return result;
}

O(log n)

log2n computes the number of times we have to do log2 to convert n to 1

if n -> 64 -> log2 -> 6

log2n -> no of times we have to do log2 to convert n to 1

n -> 64 -> n = log2 -> n = log64 -> n = 6

n=2 -> n = log2 -> n = log2 -> n = 2.8

n -> 3.2 n = log2 -> n = log3.2 -> n = 1.3

n -> 1.3, n = log2 -> n = log1.3 -> n = approx 1

for 2^ 4000340 log (2^4000340) -> 4000340

log2(2^4000340) -> 0

log2(2^4000341) -> 4000341

log(4000340) -> 16

log(16) -> 4

log(4) -> 2

log(2) -> 1